



Werner Von Braun holding a model of the V-2 rocket

to have some sort of guidance system. Von Braun's team used an ingenious combination of gyroscope sensors and rudders to achieve this.

But like with so many artefacts of war, the V-2 rocket was rushed out of production as a morale-boosting weapon for the Nazi army, which was getting hammered by the Allied Forces. So while it managed to do what it was asked, it didn't fulfil the lofty ambi-

tions of Von Braun. Germany eventually lost the war and American and Russian forces managed to capture the plans and even some of the scientists – including Von Brain – responsible for developing the rocket. This knowledge, combined with their pre-existing space programmes, led to both the US and the Russians kicking off the Space Race.

The first photo from space

When the Second World War ended, the US and Russia both stepped up their space programmes with the help of their newfound information from Germany. Once again, it was all about building a missile that was capable of long ranges – the world's first ICBM (Intercontinental Ballistic Missile).

Both sides were using the V-2 rocket as the basis of building their missiles, with the Americans having an obvious advantage since they had captured Von Braun and got him to work on their space programme. The Russians also had a few German scientists and most of Von Braun's plans to aid them in their research.

In early tests, the Americans used the V-2 rocket itself to develop their